

Draft Box - Match Engine Rulebook

Version 1.2.0 gameplay reference

Draft Setup

Each room chooses settings before draft: human slots, pick timer, rating visibility, captain mode, tournament length, draft team restrictions, rerolls and spoiler mode. Single Player creates a one-human room against 47 AI teams.

Formation Lock

Formation is selected before entering draft and is locked as soon as the draft starts. Players cannot convert a 4-3-3 into another shape mid-draft. After picks are made, users may only move or swap players between compatible slots in the same position group, so defenders swap with defenders, midfielders with midfielders, and forwards with forwards.

Experimental Single Player Auto Draft

Single Player includes an experimental Auto Draft toggle. When enabled, the server reveals eligible teams, automatically picks the strongest available XI for the locked formation, selects the highest-rated captain if captain mode is on, locks a tactical style if needed, and starts the tournament.

Match Engine Inputs

- Player overalls are weighted by slot role and pitch depth. Elite 85-91 rated players have stronger influence on goals, assists, saves and penalties.
- Chemistry measures position fit, line balance, linkage, Game Changer leadership and out-of-position penalties.
- Tactical styles apply attack, defense, tempo, risk, press, control, transition, set-piece and star-moment modifiers.
- Human teams receive a 1.2x attack and defense boost only against AI opponents. Human vs human and AI vs AI matches remain neutral.
- Starred Game Changers can create late or pressure moments after minute 80, in finals, extra time and penalty situations.

Predict Chance

The lineup reveal uses the same power model as the match engine: weighted overalls, chemistry, tactical style, Game Changer threat, formation fit and the 48-team field strength. It also projects likely goal focus, creator focus and pressure player from the same role and quality weights used by live match events.

Tournament Flow

The full format uses 48 teams in 12 groups. The top two from each group plus the best eight third-placed teams advance to Round of 32. Same-group qualifiers are separated into early knockout path blocks so they do not immediately meet again in Round of 32 or Round of 16. Knockout draws advance into a two-sided bracket with the final in the center.

Reports and Awards

After the tournament, the champion owner is shown prominently with the represented team below. Awards include Golden Ball, Golden Boot, Creator Award, Golden Glove, Knockout Hero and Heat Check. Engine Match Review

explains each user match from xG, player quality, chemistry, tactical style, star moments, shot pressure, possession, passing, saves, cards, extra time and penalties.